

GAO Reports That Public Transit Can Help Reduce Airport Road Congestion

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The U.S. Government Accountability Office (GAO) released a report on *Accessing Airports: Available Public Transit Options and Efforts to Promote Their Use*. The report reviews public transit availability, use, and strategies at 31 large and 20 medium and small airports.

GAO highlights the following:

- All but two of the airports reviewed had public transit service
- Public transit can help reduce airport road congestion
- At 12 airports with reports on passenger mode of transport, public transit use ranged from 4-19 percent
- At two large airports, 17-19 percent of surveyed airport and airline employees used public transit
- An estimated 4 percent of airport and airline employees nationwide used public transit to commute

Factors influencing transit decisions:

- Cost, travel time, and familiarity with transit options
- For people with disabilities, availability of elevators or accommodations for mobility aids

To promote transit use, some airports are implementing transportation demand management (TDM) strategies, such as:

- Additional signage and advertisements for public transportation options
- Exploring incentives, such as free rides or expedited security screenings
- Focusing on employees, who may be more willing to shift to public transit



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